

Task 10 - SDL2 Concepts

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COS30031 Games Programming

1. What is the official URL for the SDL2 website?

<https://www.libsdl.org/>

2. What does “SDL” stand for?

Simple DirectMedia Layer

3. What license is SDL2 released under?

zlib license

4. What platforms does SDL2 support?

Windows, Mac Os, Linux, iOS and Android

5. What language and standard (version) is SDL2 written in?

SDL2 is written in C and adheres to the C99 standard.

6. Where (URL) can you search the SDL API by Name for particular function or type details?

<https://wiki.libsdl.org/APIByCategory>

7. SDL can be downloaded as “Source Code”, “Runtime Binaries” or “Development Libraries”. What is the difference?

- **Source Code:** This is the raw, uncompiled code of the library. Developers can compile this themselves or look through it to understand how SDL works internally.

- **Runtime Binaries:** These are compiled DLLs (or equivalent) required to run applications that use SDL. They are meant for the end-users of the application.
- **Development Libraries:** These are the compiled libraries and header files developers need to build applications using SDL. They are meant for developers.

8. For the different download options, which one do you personally want to use with your IDE setup?

For development, you'll want the "Development Libraries" to integrate SDL into your projects. If you're just running an SDL application, you'll need the "Runtime Binaries". If you want to modify SDL itself, get the "Source Code".

9. In simple terms, what are some of the differences between a multimedia library like SDL and a “game framework”? Think about what SDL is trying to provide compared to what a game framework tries to provide.

A multimedia library like SDL provides low-level access to audio, keyboard, mouse, joystick, and graphics hardware. It's a foundation on which applications or game engines can be built. A "game framework" usually provides higher-level functionalities, tools, and abstractions specifically tailored for game development, such as physics engines, scene management, and asset handling.

10. For your particular IDE and setup, what settings are needed to make your project work with SDL2?

In visual studio 2022, I had to go to project settings and in C/C++ general settings I had to link the SDL include folder in the Additional Include Directories. Furthermore, in Linker Input settings I had to link each SDL lib file in Additional Dependencies and finally I had to import the SDL.dll to the same folder as my .exe in order to make it work.

11. What tutorial(s)/internet resource(s) did you find most useful when creating your demo program?

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-098e9w1opQ>

I watched this video as a guide on how to install SDL2 for visual studios.